

AI-POWERED MUSIC PRACTICE

Market Report and Pricing Strategy

PRIVATE-LESSON STUDENTS | HOME PRACTICE | AI FEEDBACK

"Your teacher teaches you once a week. AI helps you practice correctly the other six days."

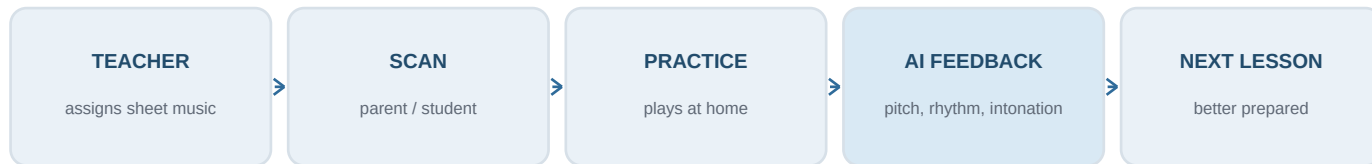
Target customer	Families with school-age instrumental students already taking weekly private lessons.
Core job	Scan the exact sheet music assigned by the teacher, manage it locally, practice against it, and receive immediate AI feedback.
Initial U.S. market model	About 1.7M-4.0M privately instructed school-age students modeled from a 3%-7% participation range; 1.2M-1.8M in the initial notation-centric serviceable segment.
Recommended launch price	\$9.99/month or \$79.99/year per family; teacher accounts free initially.

Market-sizing note. This report uses public market inputs plus explicit planning assumptions where no authoritative count exists for U.S. children receiving weekly private instrumental instruction. Figures are directional, not audited market statistics.

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1. Customer and Job to Be Done

The product is not a replacement for private instruction. It extends the teacher relationship into the unsupervised practice days between lessons.



The product is the between-lesson loop, not a replacement for the private teacher.

The parent-paid use case

#	Moment	What the product does
1	Teacher assigns	A physical page, PDF, method book excerpt, etude, excerpt, or marked-up score.
2	Family captures	Parent or student scans / photographs the assigned music and stores it in a private library.
3	Student practices	The app follows the score while the child plays on the actual instrument.
4	AI evaluates	Pitch, rhythm, timing and - where technically reliable - intonation and tempo stability.
5	Practice improves	The app identifies problem measures, recommends repetition and records progress.
6	Teacher benefits	The next lesson starts with better-prepared repertoire and an optional concise practice summary.

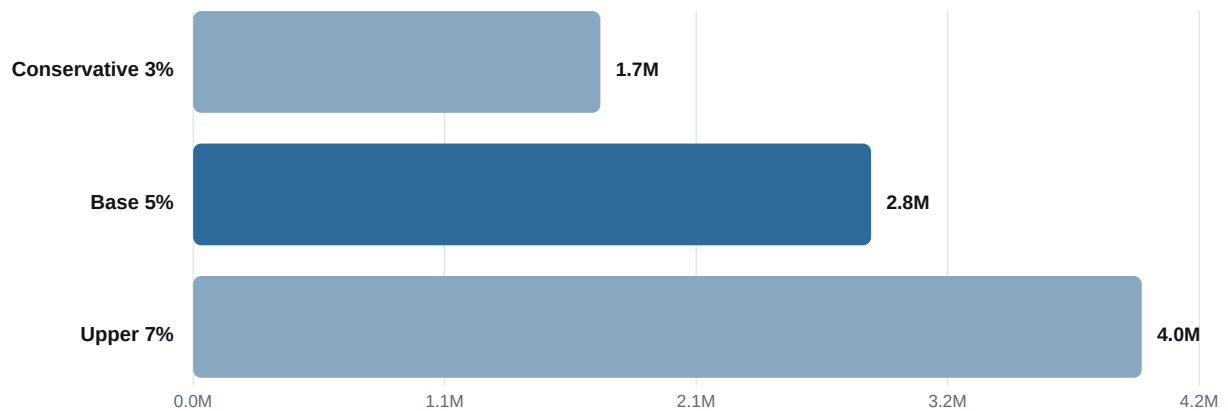
Why this customer is attractive: families already paying for private lessons have demonstrated willingness to spend on music education. Music & Arts publicly describes a typical 30-minute lesson at roughly \$37/week, making an \$80-\$120 annual software subscription a small fraction of the existing family spend. [2]

Core positioning: **Bring your own teacher. Bring your own sheet music.**

2. U.S. Market Model

There is no single authoritative current count of school-age children receiving weekly private instrumental lessons. The market should therefore be presented as a transparent bottom-up model rather than a false-precision statistic.

~56.5M	3%-7%	~1.7M-4.0M
U.S. elementary + secondary students - planning input [1]	Modeled share taking private instrumental lessons	Modeled privately instructed students



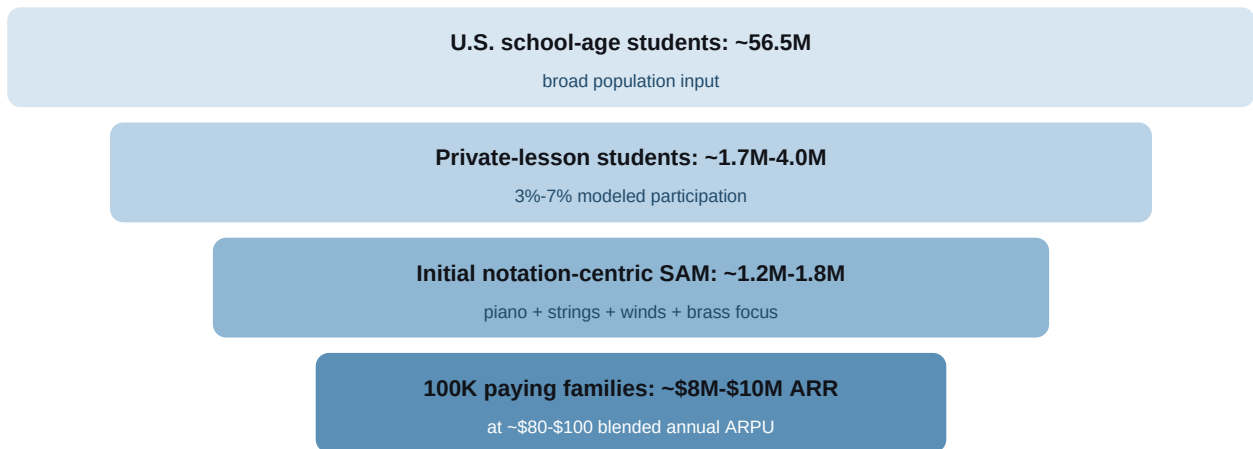
Base-case logic

Using a 5% planning assumption on roughly 56.5 million school-age students produces about 2.8 million actively privately instructed students. The 3%-7% range is deliberately wide because participation varies strongly by income, geography, age and instrument.

The range is directionally supported by the scale of the private-instruction ecosystem: MTNA reports roughly 17,000 members, and Music & Arts reports more than 1.5 million private lessons taught annually across its own network. [3][4]

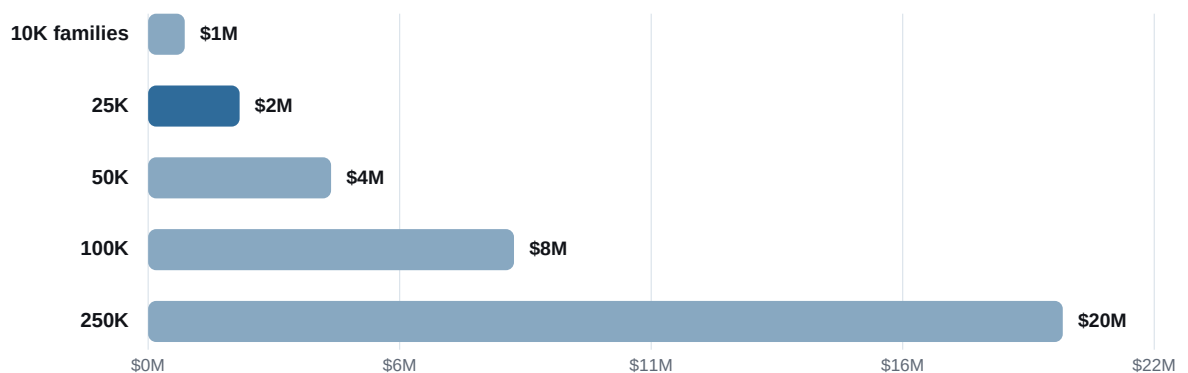
3. TAM, SAM and Revenue Scenarios

The economically relevant market is not all music education spending; it is what lesson-taking households could reasonably pay for a between-lesson digital practice companion.



Annual software opportunity at approximately \$90 ARPU

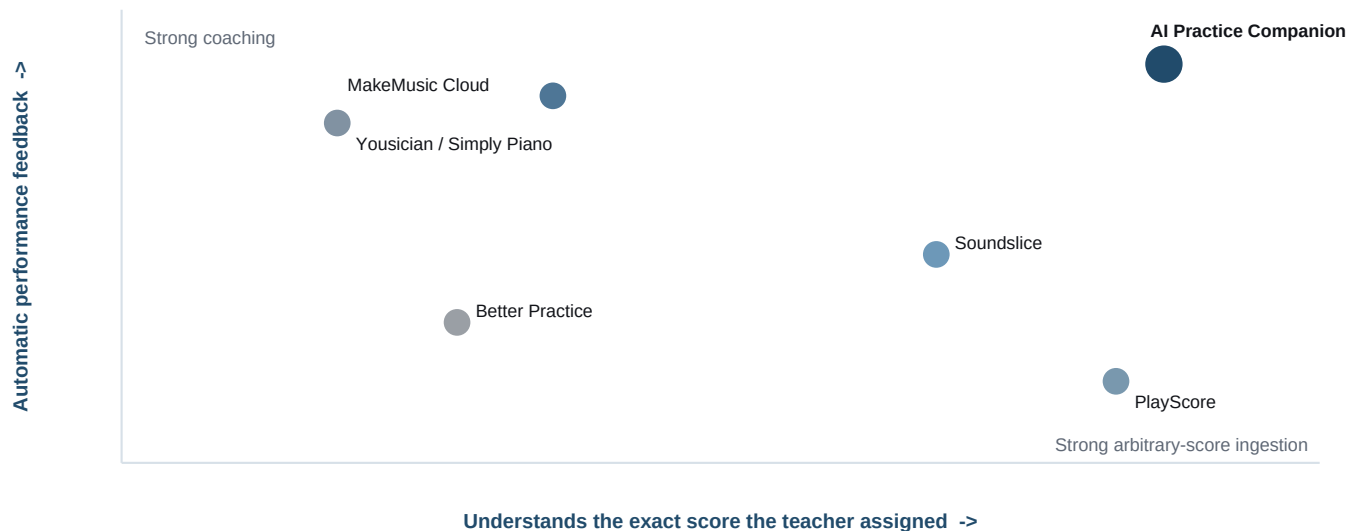
Scenario	Students / families	Implied annual software spend
Conservative TAM	~1.7M	~\$153M
Base TAM	~2.8M	~\$252M
Upper TAM	~4.0M	~\$360M
Initial SAM	~1.2M-1.8M	~\$110M-\$160M



Key takeaway: the product does not require mass-market adoption. Approximately 100,000 paying families can support an \$8M-\$10M ARR business before adding school, studio or international channels.

4. Competitive Landscape and Product Whitespace

Existing products prove demand for both sides of the workflow, but few products tightly connect arbitrary teacher-assigned sheet music with automatic performance coaching.



Product	Primary strength	Gap relative to this concept
PlayScore	Scan arbitrary printed music, follow and play back the score.	Not primarily a student performance coach.
MakeMusic Cloud	Real-time pitch / rhythm assessment against interactive scores.	Less centered on arbitrary physical scores from a private teacher.
Soundslice	Interactive scores, scanning, practice tools and teacher workflows.	Automatic real-time performance assessment is not the core proposition.
Better Practice	Assignments, practice tracking, parent and teacher workflow.	Does not deeply understand and assess the notation being played.
Yousician / Simply Piano	Guided curriculum with listening-based feedback.	Curriculum-first rather than "bring your own teacher and score."

Product whitespace: Scan the score your teacher actually assigned -> understand its notes -> listen while the child performs -> coach the practice session -> summarize progress for the family and optionally the teacher.

5. Pricing Strategy

The app should be priced as a supplement to private instruction, not as a full curriculum replacement. A family plan is more natural than charging separately for each child.

FREE \$0 3 saved pieces 3 AI assessments / week Playback + follow score Tuner + metronome	FAMILY \$79.99 / year \$9.99 monthly option Up to 3 student profiles Unlimited local score library AI pitch + rhythm feedback Practice history	FAMILY PRO \$119.99 / year Deeper intonation analysis Problem-measure detection Weekly AI practice plan Parent summary Teacher progress report
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Recommended launch structure

Tier	Role	Rationale
Free	Acquisition	Let the family experience the recognition and listening "magic" before paying. Do not make scanning itself the main paywall.
Family - \$79.99/year	Core conversion	Strong value relative to private-lesson spend; annual plan should be the default purchase path.
Family Pro - \$119.99/year	Upsell	Charge for deeper AI coaching: intonation, problem-measure detection, practice planning, richer reports.
Teacher - free initially	Distribution	One trusted teacher can recommend the product to 10-30+ families. Lower friction matters more than near-term teacher ARPU.
Studio - later	B2B2C	Potential \$2-\$3 per active student per month, bundled into studio tuition or software fees.

Reference points at time of review include MakeMusic Cloud individual access near \$59.99/year, Soundslice Plus near \$50/year, Better Practice near \$4.25/month for students, and higher-priced curriculum / content subscriptions such as Tomplay. Public prices can change. [5][6][7][8]

6. Go-to-Market: Make Teachers the Distribution Channel

The strongest acquisition loop is teacher-led, because the private teacher already has trust, context and a recurring reason to recommend a practice tool.

1 teacher	10-30+	\$0
Trusted recommender	Potential family referrals	Recommended teacher price at launch

Teacher-led growth loop

1. Teacher assigns Score, measures, tempo or practice goal.	2. Family activates Scans once and starts using the assigned score.
4. Teacher sees progress Optional summary before the next lesson.	3. Student practices AI provides immediate feedback and repetition guidance.

North-star product metric

Successful Practice Days per Student per Week

The most important proof is not scans, pages or app opens. It is whether students practice more consistently and make fewer repeated mistakes before the next lesson.

Secondary metrics

Practice frequency	Accuracy improvement	Mastery speed
Active practice days / week; sessions / week.	Pitch, rhythm and intonation change across repeated takes.	Time or attempts from first play-through to accepted measure.
Teacher confirmation	Retention	Family engagement
Teacher says student arrived better prepared.	3 / 6 / 12-month paid family retention.	Parent summaries opened; pieces completed.

7. Risks, Validation Priorities and Sources

The market thesis is promising, but the business depends on solving a few measurable product risks before scaling distribution.

Highest-priority validation questions

Risk	Question	Validation
OMR reliability	Can ordinary parents scan teacher-assigned music with a low enough correction burden?	Measure % of measures requiring zero correction.
Audio assessment	Can the app robustly evaluate real acoustic instruments in a home environment?	Test violin, piano and one wind instrument across phones and rooms.
Feedback quality	Does AI feedback help rather than distract or contradict the teacher?	Co-design feedback language with private teachers.
Retention	Does the product create a weekly habit after the novelty of scanning fades?	Track successful practice days and 8-12 week retention.
Teacher adoption	Will teachers recommend it without feeling displaced?	Position as between-lesson support; teacher control and summaries are opt-in.
Copyright / privacy	Can user-owned score storage and child audio be handled safely?	Local-first score storage where practical; clear parental controls and data policy.

Sources and public inputs

[1] NCES, enrollment / school population tables used as a planning input: <https://nces.ed.gov/programs/digest/>

[2] Music & Arts, lesson pricing / FAQ: <https://www.musicarts.com/cms/faq/buying-lessons/how-much-do-lessons-cost>

[3] Music Teachers National Association, membership information: <https://www.mtna.org/Membership.html>

[4] Music & Arts, company overview / private lesson scale: <https://www.musicarts.com/cms/about-us>

[5] MakeMusic Cloud individual subscription information: <https://help.makemusic.com/>

[6] Soundslice plans and pricing: <https://www.soundslice.com/plans/>

[7] Better Practice pricing: <https://betterpracticeapp.com/pricing>

[8] Tomplay Premium pricing: <https://tomplay.com/premium>

[9] PlayScore product information: <https://www.playscore.co/>

[10] Broader online music education market reference points: Research and Markets / Knowledge Sourcing Intelligence and Mordor Intelligence market reports.

Methodology disclaimer. Participation assumptions, TAM, SAM and revenue scenarios are management planning estimates derived from public inputs and explicit adoption / pricing assumptions. They are not audited industry totals and should be refreshed before use in formal fundraising materials.

Market conclusion. A credible initial U.S. opportunity is roughly 1.2M-1.8M notation-centric privately taught students, supporting an estimated \$110M-\$160M annual serviceable software market. A focused goal of 100K paying families could support approximately \$8M-\$10M ARR, with teacher-led distribution as a key efficiency advantage.